

Graph Theory Notes

Jesse Oldroyd

June 30, 2026

2026-06-30

Graph Theory Notes

Graph Theory Notes

Jesse Oldroyd
June 30, 2026

Introduction to Graph Theory

2026-06-30

Graph Theory Notes

└ Outline

Outline

Introduction to Graph Theory

2026-06-30

Graph Theory Notes
└ Introduction to Graph Theory

Introduction to Graph Theory

Introduction to Graph Theory

- Much like group theory is the mathematical language of symmetry, graph theory provides languages for expressing relationships

Applications of graph theory

- Modeling networks
- Chemistry
- Machine learning
- Routing problems
- CYOA

2026-06-30

Graph Theory Notes

└ Introduction to Graph Theory

└ Networks and Relationships

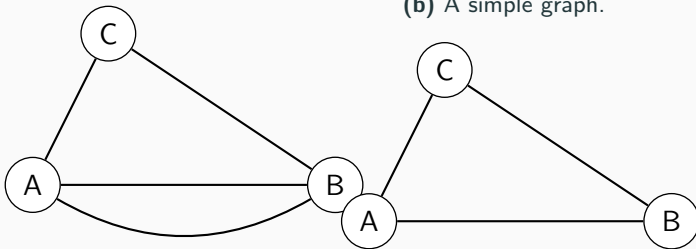
- Much like group theory is the mathematical language of symmetry, graph theory provides languages for expressing relationships

Applications of graph theory

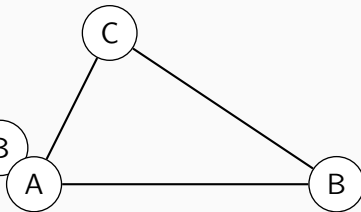
- Modeling networks
- Chemistry
- Machine learning
- Routing problems
- CYOA

- A **graph** $\mathcal{G} = (V, E)$ is a set V of **vertices** together with a set E of **edges**. Two vertices are **adjacent** or neighbors if they are connected by an edge.
- A **simple graph** is a graph with at most one edge between any pair of vertices and no loops.

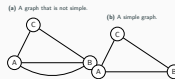
(a) A graph that is not simple.



(b) A simple graph.



- A **graph** $G = (V, E)$ is a set V of **vertices** together with a set E of **edges**. Two vertices are **adjacent** or neighbors if they are connected by an edge.
- A **simple graph** is a graph with at most one edge between any pair of vertices and no loops.



- A friendship graph is a graph where each pair of vertices have exactly one neighbor (i.e., the "friend") in common.

Example (Friendship graphs)

Draw examples of friendship graphs.

2026-06-30

Graph Theory Notes

- └ Introduction to Graph Theory
 - └ Friendship

Friendship

- A friendship graph is a graph where each pair of vertices have exactly one neighbor (i.e., the "friend") in common.

Example (Friendship graphs)

Draw examples of friendship graphs.

Example (Finding degrees, paths and cycles)

Find the following using the graph below:

1. The degree of each vertex.
2. The number of paths from vertex 1 to vertex 6.
3. The length of the shortest path from vertex 1 to vertex 6.

Figure 2: A graph that is not simple.

7

Degrees, Paths and Cycles

- The **degree** of a vertex is the number of edges adjacent to that vertex. A **path** between two vertices is a series of distinct, adjacent vertices that connects the vertices. A **cycle** is a path that starts and ends at the same vertex.

Example (Finding degrees, paths and cycles)

Find the following using the graph below:

1. The degree of each vertex.
2. The number of paths from vertex 1 to vertex 6.
3. The length of the shortest path from vertex 1 to vertex 6.

Figure 2: A graph that is not simple.

7

Example (Scheduling tournaments)

Suppose six teams are playing in a tournament and each team must play exactly three others. How can this be done? What if only five teams are playing?

2026-06-30

Graph Theory Notes

└ Introduction to Graph Theory

└ An Application

Example (Scheduling tournaments)

Suppose six teams are playing in a tournament and each team must play exactly three others. How can this be done? What if only five teams are playing?

An Impossibility Proof

Example (Not scheduling tournaments)

Prove that it's impossible to schedule a tournament for five teams such that each team plays exactly three others.

2026-06-30

Graph Theory Notes

└ Introduction to Graph Theory

└ An Impossibility Proof

Look at previous examples and try to find a relationship between degrees and edges.

Example (Utility graph)

Three houses A , B and C must be connected to three utilities E (electric), G (gas) and W (water). Each house must be connected to each utility exactly once. What graph represents this situation?

Example (Utility graph)

Three houses A , B and C must be connected to three utilities E (electric), G (gas) and W (water). Each house must be connected to each utility exactly once. What graph represents this situation?

- A **bipartite graph** is a graph with one group of m vertices and another group of n vertices such that each vertex is adjacent to all of the vertices in the other group and adjacent to none of the vertices in their own group. This graph is denoted by $K_{m,n}$.
- The utility graph is $K_{3,3}$.

Employment

Suppose that four employers (labeled A, B, C, D) are recruiting from a shared pool of four applicants (labeled $1, 2, 3, 4$). The employers and applicants have ranked each other as follows:

Applicant	Employer rankings	Employer	Applicant rankings
1	A, B, C, D	A	4, 2, 1, 3
2	A, B, D, C	B	2, 1, 3, 4
3	B, A, C, D	C	1, 3, 4, 2
4	D, A, B, C	D	1, 3, 2, 4

Employers will make offers to applicants, but applicants are allowed to change their minds if a better offer comes along. Is there a *stable matching*, i.e., a situation where no applicant will change their mind?

Note

An example of an unstable matching is the following:

2026-06-30

Stable Matchings

Employment

Suppose that four employers (labeled A, B, C, D) are recruiting from a shared pool of four applicants (labeled $1, 2, 3, 4$). The employers and applicants have ranked each other as follows:

Applicant	Employer rankings	Employer	Applicant rankings
1	A, B, C, D	A	4, 2, 1, 3
2	A, B, D, C	B	2, 1, 3, 4
3	B, A, C, D	C	1, 3, 4, 2
4	D, A, B, C	D	1, 3, 2, 4

Employers will make offers to applicants, but applicants are allowed to change their minds if a better offer comes along. Is there a *stable matching*, i.e., a situation where no applicant will change their mind?

Note

An example of an unstable matching is the following: